

The Grasslands

*A grassland is an area of land that mostly contains grasses. There are wild grasses and there may be some trees. From the hot equatorial region to the cold polar region, grasslands are found all over the world. However, their characteristics and physical attributes change with the change in the climate. Thus, based on the climatic factors the grassland can be categorized into two parts-

1. Tropical Grasslands- These are located near the equator (10° to 25° North or South Latitudes), between the Tropic of Cancer and Tropic of Capricorn. The Tropical Grasslands are also known as Savannas. The **Savanna** grasslands are mostly found in East Africa. They are also found in the Orinioco basin (Venezuela and Colombia), Brazil, Honduras and the southern parts of India. These grasslands are known by different names in different parts of the world. In Africa, they are known as Savanna, **Llanos** in Venezuela and Colombia. Campos in Brazil, Paraguay, Argentina and Uruguay. **Selvas** (Selva) are tropical evergreen rainforests in the Amazon Basin.

2. Temperate Grasslands- Located between 30° to 45° North and South Latitudes. Due to greater territorial expansion in the Northern Hemisphere, these grasslands (in Northern Hemisphere) may extend up 50° North Latitude. The major temperate grasslands include the **Velds** of Africa, the **Pampas** of Argentina, the **Steppes** of Eurasia, the **Prairies** of North America, and the Downs of Australia. *The Prairie grasslands are found in North America. *The Pampas grasslands are mostly found in Argentina, though they also extend to Uruguay and Brazil. *The temperate grasslands found in Eurasia (Eastern Europe and Central Asia) are known as steppes. The temperate grasslands found in South Africa are called velds. *Downs are temperate grasslands found in Australia.

1. Match List - I with List - II and using the given codes select the correct answer :

List - I (Grassland)	List - II (Country / Continent)
A. Steppes	1. United States of America
B. Prairies	2. South Africa
C. Welds	3. Russia
D. Downs	4. Australia

Codes :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	1	3	4
(b)	1	4	2	3
(c)	3	1	2	4
(d)	4	2	3	1

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

The correct match is as follows :

Grassland	Country / Continent
Steppes	Russia
Prairies	United States of America
Welds	South Africa
Downs	Australia

2. Which one of the following is not correctly matched?

(a) Prairies	-	North America
(b) Pampas	-	South America
(c) Steppes	-	Europe
(d) Veld	-	Australia

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (d)

The correctly matched pairs are as follows :

Prairies	-	North America
Pampas	-	South America
Steppes	-	Europe
Veld	-	South Africa

3. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the codes given below :

List - I (Grassland)	List-II (Continent)
A. Llanos	1. North America
B. Steppe	2. Africa
C. Prairies	3. Europe
D. Veld	4. South America

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	4	3	1	2
(b)	2	3	4	1
(c)	4	3	2	1
(d)	4	1	3	2

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (a)

The correctly matched grasslands with their continents are as follows:

Llanos	-	South America
Steppe	-	Europe
Prairies	-	North America
Veld	-	Africa

4. Which of the following pair is correct ?

Countries		Grass fields
(a) Kenya	-	Campos
(b) Argentina	-	Pampas
(c) Venezuela	-	Savanna
(d) United States of America	-	the Steppe

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (b)

The correct match of grass fields with respective countries/ regions is as follows :

Campos	-	Brazilian Highland
Pampas	-	Argentina, Uruguay and Brazil
Savanna	-	Eastern Africa (Kenya, Tanzania etc)
Steppes	-	Eastern Europe and Central Asia
Therefore, option (b) is correctly matched.		

5. The Savannas are most widespread in –

- | | |
|-------------------|-------------------|
| (a) Africa | (b) Asia |
| (c) North America | (d) South America |

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (a)

Savanna is a rolling grassland scattered with shrubs and isolated trees which can be found between a tropical rainforest and desert biome. The savannas are mainly spread, over East Africa. Savannas are also found in Brazil, Colombia, Venezuela, Belize, Honduras and the southern parts of India. Therefore, the correct answer is option (a).

6. What is the name of mid-latitude grassland in South America?

- (a) Prairie
(b) Pampas
(c) Veld
(d) Steppes
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

Mid-latitudes or temperate belt grasslands of South America are known as Pampas. They are spread over Argentina, Uruguay and southern parts of Brazil. Other mid-latitude grasslands are Prairie (North America), Downs (Australia), etc.

7. Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A) : The Pampas plain is the main region for cultivation in Argentina.

Reason (R) : The fertile soil of Pampas and the temperate climate are very useful for growing crops and grasses.

Choose the correct answer from the code given below.

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
(c) (A) is true but (R) is false
(d) (A) is false but (R) is true

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (a)

The Pampas of South America are a grassland biome. They are flat, fertile plains, found primarily in Argentina and extend into Uruguay and Brazil. Because of the temperate climate and rich, deep soil, most of the Pampas have been brought under cultivation and turned into croplands.

8. The wide treeless grassy plain in South America are called

- | | |
|--------------|-------------|
| (a) Selvas | (b) Pampas |
| (c) Prairies | (d) Steppes |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

Pampas are the grasslands of South America. These plains are very fertile. These grass fields spread from the Atlantic Ocean to the Andes Mountains up to Argentina, Brazil and Uruguay.

9. Which of the following is correctly matched

- | | | |
|------------|---|-----------------|
| (a) Campos | - | Northern Brazil |
| (b) Llanos | - | Venezuela |
| (c) Pampas | - | Chile |
| (d) Selvas | - | Southern Brazil |

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (b)

Llanos grasslands are found in Venezuela and Colombia while Campos, Pampas and fields are found in mainly Southeast Brazil and Argentina respectively. Selvas (Selva) are tropical evergreen rainforests in Amazon Basin.

10. Which one of the following is not correctly matched ?

- | | | |
|-------------|---|---------------------|
| (a) Downs | - | Tropical grassland |
| (b) Steppes | - | Temperate grassland |

- (c) Selva - Tropical forest
(d) Taiga - Temperate forest

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2002

Ans. (a)

Tropical grass fields are found amid equatorial evergreen forests and hot desert areas. Examples of such grass fields are as follows – Llanos, Campos and Savanna. Temperate grass fields are stretched across the region of temperate climate. Examples of these grasslands are Prairies, Pampas, Steppes, Veld and Downs. Selvas (Selva) are tropical evergreen rainforests in the Amazon Basin. Thus, option (a) is not correctly matched while the other options are correctly matched.

11. Which of the following is not a temperate grassland?

- (a) Pampas (b) Veld
(c) Downs (d) Savanna

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2013

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

12. In which one of the following countries are Pampas Grasslands located ?

- (a) Paraguay (b) Bolivia
(c) Argentina (d) Uruguay

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

Ans. (c)

Pampas grasslands are located mainly in the South American country Argentina but some of their portions are also located in Uruguay and Brazil. Therefore, option (c) can be the correct answer.

13. In which of the following countries is the Pampas grasslands situated?

- (a) Argentina (b) Brazil
(c) Chile (d) Ecuador

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

14. Which of the following temperate grasslands are found in Eurasia ?

- (a) Downs (b) Velds
(c) Steppes (d) Prairies

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (c)

The temperate grassland found in the Eurasia region is Steppes.

15. Which one of the following natural regions is known as 'Land of Big Games'?

- (a) Temperate Grassland
(b) Tropical Monsoon Region
(c) Hot Desert Region
(d) Tropical Savanna Region

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (d)

Land of Big Games is known as the Tropical Savanna region, as thousands of animals are trapped or killed each year by people from all over the world. There are two main groups of animals in the savanna, the grass-eating herbivorous animals and the flesh-eating carnivorous animals. The herbivorous include the zebra, antelope, giraffe, deer, gazelle, elephant etc. and carnivorous animals include the lion, tiger, jackal, jaguar, leopard, hyena etc. Species of reptiles and mammals include giant lizards, crocodiles, alligators that live together with larger rhinoceroses and hippopotamuses in rivers and marshy lakes.

16. The vegetation of savannah consists of grassland with scattered small trees, but extensive areas have no trees. The forest development in such areas is generally kept in check by one or more or a combination of some conditions. Which of the following are such conditions?

1. Burrowing animals and termites
2. Fire
3. Grazing herbivores
4. Seasonal rainfall
5. Soil properties

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 4 and 5
(c) 2, 3 and 4 (d) 1, 3 and 5

I.A.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

The main obstacle in the development of forest in the savanna grassland is the abundance of grass-grazing animals, fire in this area and seasonal rainfall. Due to seasonal rains, everything dries up in the summer in this region, due to which the development of forest is not possible in this area.

17. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists :

List-I (Grasslands)	List-II (Countries)
A. Pampas	1. Australia
B. Pustaz	2. South Africa